

Washing instructions

Pin this next to the board. Washing is on the other sheet.
Generic front loader, 1–8 kg · Generic steam iron

ON THE BOARD

#	Pile	Thermostat	Steam	Why not / how
1	Dark	••	yes	Inside out, medium heat
2	Merino Wool	••	yes	Only if you must
3	Cashmere Blend	••	yes	Low heat through a pressing cloth
4	White	•••	yes	Iron while slightly damp, steam on
5	Coloured	•••	yes	Steam, but turn prints and dark panels inside out first
6	Denim	•••	yes	Inside out on cotton heat if you want them crisp
7	Linen	MAX	yes	While still damp, hottest setting, steam first
8	White Socks	do not iron	—	
9	White Towels	do not iron	—	Ironing crushes the pile flat and the towel stops drying you
10	Coloured Socks	do not iron	—	
11	Coloured Towels	do not iron	—	Ironing crushes the pile flat and the towel stops drying you
12	Microfibre Towels	do not iron	—	Polyester and polyamide start melting around 110 °C, well before the iron does anything useful
13	Black Socks	do not iron	—	
14	Raw Denim	do not iron	—	Pressing sets creases in the wrong places and flattens the fades that took months to earn
15	Synthetic Activewear	do not iron	—	Elastane starts degrading around 110 °C, and the technical finish goes with it
16	Gym Socks	do not iron	—	
17	Wool Trainers	do not iron	—	



thermostat

The ring is the iron's thermostat as it sits on the dial, and the red pointer is where to turn it. The blue band is the zone where it makes steam; a setting below it is a dry iron. A crossed-out ring means leave the iron in the cupboard.

1. ● — wool, silk · 150 °C

3 piles



Thermostat on ●
inside the steam zone

HOW

Dark

Merino Wool

Cashmere Blend

— [Icebreaker on merino](#)

Inside out, medium heat. Steam, don't press hard — shine on dark cotton doesn't come out.

Only if you must: pressing cloth, no weight. Hanging it in a steamy bathroom drops the creases without touching it.

Low heat through a pressing cloth. Better still, steam it on a hanger and let the creases drop out on their own.

2. ●● — cotton, linen · 200 °C

3 piles



Thermostat on ●●
inside the steam zone

HOW

White

Coloured

Denim

Iron while slightly damp, steam on. Cotton takes all the heat the iron has.

Steam, but turn prints and dark panels inside out first.

Inside out on cotton heat if you want them crisp. Steam.

3. MAX — linen · 230 °C

1 pile



Thermostat on MAX
inside the steam zone

HOW

Linen

While still damp, hottest setting, steam first.

4. Do not iron

10 piles



Leave the iron off
nothing on this card ever goes near the board

NEVER THESE

White Socks

White Towels

Coloured Socks

Coloured Towels

Ironing crushes the pile flat and the towel stops drying you.

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Microfibre Towels	Polyester and polyamide start melting around 110 °C, well before the iron does anything useful.
Black Socks	
Raw Denim	Pressing sets creases in the wrong places and flattens the fades that took months to earn.
Synthetic Activewear	Elastane starts degrading around 110 °C, and the technical finish goes with it.
Gym Socks	
Wool Trainers	
— Dirty Labs on synthetic activewear	